
Beyond and Between Our Screens

How design ethnography is informing the
evolution of Hansard's technology

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29 July 2026



Introducing Hansard

Presented by Charlie Browne (Managing Editor, House of Commons Hansard)

What is the Official Report (Hansard)?

Wednesday
29 October 2025

Volume 774
No. 198



HOUSE OF COMMONS
OFFICIAL REPORT

PARLIAMENTARY
DEBATES
(HANSARD)

Wednesday 29 October 2025

COMMONS COMMONS COMM

VOL.590 VOL.591 VOL.592 VOL.593 VOL.594 VOL.595

UK Parliament

Hansard

UK Parliament > Hansard > Commons: 29 October 2025

Select a date

October 2025

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29 30 1 2 3 4 5

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Today: 30/10/2025

Days with content Deleted day Weekend

Downloads

Download content and documents relevant to the day's proceedings.

Whole day
Download the Hansard record of the entire day in PDF format.
PDF file, 1.21 MB

Other PDF and HTML downloads

Commons Hansard for 29 October 2025 (V)

From the corrected (daily) version. Last updated 30 October

Commons Chamber
Record of debates that happened in the House of Commons main chamber

- House of Commons
- Oral Answers to Questions
- Gaza and Hamas
- Asylum Seekers: MOD Housing
- UK-Türkiye Typhoon Export Deal
- Points of Order
- European Convention on Human Rights (Withdrawal)
- Sentencing Bill
- Privileges
- Business without Debate
- Offshore Wind Supply Chain: Tyneside

Westminster Hall
Westminster Hall debates give Members an opportunity to raise local response from a government minister.

Select meeting

October 2025							Title	Venue	Start Time	Status
Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa	Su	Scottish Affairs Committee	CR 05	09:23:00	Adjourn
29	30	1	2	3	4	5	Second Delegated Legislation Committee	CR 11	09:25:00	Adjourn
6	7	8	9	10	11	12	PBC 283 am	CR 14	09:25:00	Adjourn
13	14	15	16	17	18	19	Backup Westminster Hall	Westminster Hall_Backup	09:30:00	Adjourn
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	Westminster Hall	Westminster Hall	09:30:00	Adjourn
27	28	29	30	31	1	2	Science and Technology Committee	CR 08	09:33:00	Adjourn
3	4	5	6	7	8	9	Education Committee	Thatcher	09:33:00	Adjourn
Today: 30/10/2025							Science, Innovation and Technology Committ	CR 08	09:33:00	Adjourn
All categories							Industry and Regulators	CR 02	09:55:00	Adjourn
House of Commons Chamber							Housing, Communities and Local Governmen	Macmillan	09:59:00	Adjourn
House of Commons Committee							Environment, Food and Rural Affairs Committ	CR 06	10:02:00	Adjourn
House of Lords Chamber							Treasury Committee	Grimond	10:04:00	Adjourn
House of Lords Committees							Foreign Affairs Committee	CR 16	10:06:00	Adjourn
Joint Committee Meetings										



How is Hansard produced?



Always someone from the Hansard team **in the room**

Reporters produce **substantially verbatim** five-minute chunks of proceedings

Sub-editors proofread, sense-check and publish online to **tight deadlines**



Hansard's tools

Find transcripts

Select date

08/07/2026

Event or venue name

Enter keyword

Status

All

In-progress

Adjourned

House

All

Commons

Lords

Joint

Reset

Search

Chambers

Lords Chamber

3:15pm to 3:45pm

Lords Chamber

Adjourned

Lords

Committees

Transport Committee

10:00am to 10:30am

Grimond Room

Adjourned

Commons

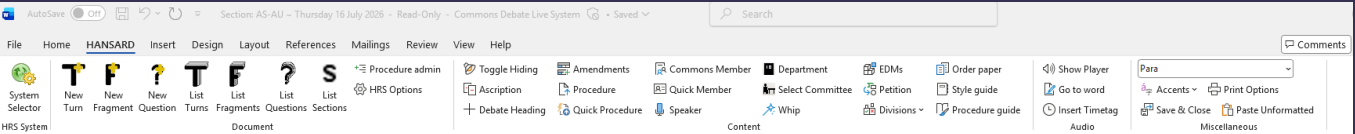
Scottish Affairs Committee

10:55am to 11:25am

Committee Room 6

Adjourned

Commons



private sector across the steel industry. From our side, the partnership comes with significant resources on the table, through the National Wealth Fund, to help the steel industry become more competitive, particularly on energy efficiency.

S.SQ John Slinger (Rugby) (Lab): Our energy, defence and railway sectors depend on steel. Does my hon. Friend agree that steel made by British workers, in Britain, and owned by the British people, is not only in our infrastructure interest but in our national interest?

S.Ans Blair McDougall: I could not agree more. On a day when many of us will be thinking about travelling back to our constituencies by rail for the summer, it is worth noting that 80% of the rails we will be travelling on are made by British Steel. My hon. Friend raises an important point about taking more steps to ensure, as taxpayers would expect, that when we engage in public procurement British Steel is firmly in the mix.

S.SQ Richard Tice (Boston and Skegness) (Reform): Congratulations to the Government on doing what I have been urging for seven years, which is to take this strategic national asset into public ownership. What is needed now is a comprehensive, bold vision for the blast furnaces. I am concerned about the talk about more electric arc furnaces. We already have them at Rotherham, and others are being built down in Port Talbot. We need a comprehensive vision to invest in blast furnace plate mills, so we have a real job-creating, world-class industry based around Scunthorpe in the great county of



Design ethnography in practice

Presented by Michael Kibedi (User Researcher, Parliamentary Digital Service)

How ethnographic research supported our aims

Aim

- **Observe and understand** how Hansard reporters and sub-editors produce the Official Report
- **Identify unarticulated opportunities** for improving the coherence of their digital tools

Ethnographic research is an **open-ended** observation – conducted over days rather than minutes

Ethnographic research is a way to understand what people do in their **natural environment**

Ethnographic research gives us an opportunity to witness or gather **unexpected insights**



Who and what we observed

Oral questions where peers ask ministers about **any** aspect of Government policy

Committee stage of a Government Bill where peers scrutinise and amend proposed legislation

2

Hansard reporters

1

Hansard sub-editor



2

Hansard reporters

2

Hansard sub-editors

Oral questions where backbench MPs ask ministers about **their specific** departmental policy

Westminster Hall debate where backbench MPs lead debates on local or national issues not requiring a vote

Delegated Legislation Committee where Government ministers make changes to existing law under pre-agreed powers

Applying ethnographic research theory

Distributed Cognition for Teamwork is a way of interpreting how people **working in teams** using **many systems** towards **a shared goal**



“Most interactive systems do not consist of a single user with a single computer, **yet established methods for reasoning about the design and use of systems are still best suited for single-user-single-device systems.**” (pg. 1, lightly edited)

DiCoT: A methodology for applying Distributed Cognition to the design of team working systems by Ann Blandford and Dominic Furniss (2005)

Design Ethnography

Research, Responsibilities, and Futures

Sarah Pink, Vaike Fors, Debora Lanzeni, Melisa Duque, Shanti Sumartojo, and Yolande Strengers

“Design ethnography promotes an approach that is committed to **interdisciplinary practice and understanding.** It also recognises that this might have multiple forms and orientations. Although single-discipline approaches produce crucial insights, their narrowness inhibits their ability to bring about effective approaches to change.” (pg. 3, lighted edited)

Design Ethnography: Research, Responsibilities, and Futures by Sarah Pink et al. (Routledge, 2022)

My research was interested in the interplay of **spatial design, interaction design, and cognitive science**

What was I observing?

Physical layout

Space and place, in and around systems

- Working space and how it aids cognition and computation
- Spatial support for shared understanding of what's finished/in progress/next

Artefacts

Environment, representations, objects

- Artefacts mediating task completion, for example: whiteboards, notepads, procedural papers
- How people create realistic or abstract representations of information to support their task
- How cognitive offloading aids task completion

Information flow

How knowledge is created and transformed

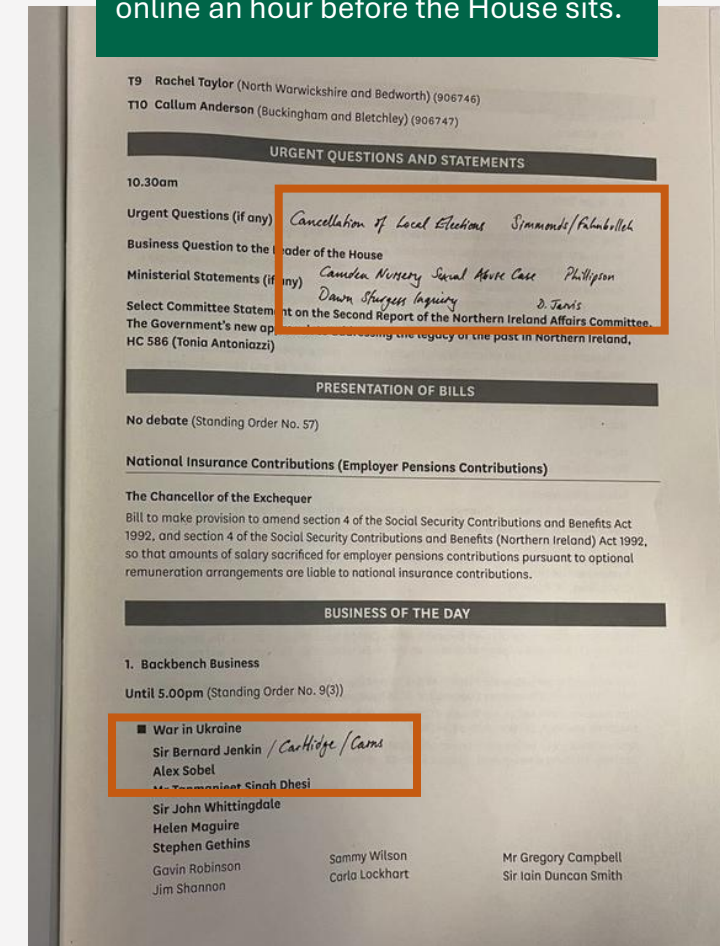
- Information and how it is represented, collectively perceived and processed
- How individuals and group use and share information
- Social exchange within/across groups

"The Reporters' Room is a bit like a corridor. **Lots of people are always going through.** We host a lot of visitors."

House of Commons Hansard staff

House of Commons Hansard Reporters' Room, 30 Jan 2026.
Photo taken on a non-sitting day with kind permission of Hansard

Urgent questions and ministerial statements are approved by the Speaker's Office and published online an hour before the House sits.



Chamber and Committees

Hansard reporters in the Commons have a dedicated row in the front row of the Press Gallery, above the Speaker's chair



Hansard reporters in the Lords have space on the Government side on the floor of the House



Second Delegated Legislation Committee: Draft Online Safety Act 2023 (Offences) (Amendment) Regulations 2025, held on 18 November 2025 at 14:30. Still taken from Parliament Live TV.

Three insights

1

Hansard's reporters and editors work across too many interfaces, applications, and portals – which makes the process of reporting and editing more complex than it needs to be

2

Hansard's style guides and dictionaries are not integrated with their reporting software – which causes staff to continually interrupt their flow, which is a disruptive user experience

3

Hansard's managing editors lack a comprehensive view of intraday publishing progress – which means they have an incomplete understanding as sittings progress

We have questions for YOU!

Have you used ethnographic methods in your organisation? If you have, we are keen to learn from you:

- How have you got around doing in-person research fieldwork with people or in places that are difficult to access?
- How have you communicated your ethnographic research findings? Have they differed from the ways you have share other types of research?
- Are there situations where you have considered using ethnography but decided against it? What drove that decision?



Thank you.

... and if you would like to learn more about Hansard by shadowing a reporter in the Chamber, speak to Charlie



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